

Week-4 practical

Task-1

Write a C program where a parent process creates multiple child processes and synchronizes their completion using `wait()` and `waitpid()`. Compare the behavior of both functions.

```
GNU nano 7.2 wait_e
#include <stdio.h>
#include <stdlib.h>
#include <unistd.h>
#include <sys/wait.h>

int main()
{
    pid_t children[3];
    int status;

    printf("Parent PID = %d\n", getpid());

    // Create 3 child processes
    for (int i = 0; i < 3; i++)
    {
        children[i] = fork();

        if (children[i] < 0)
        {
            perror("fork failed");
            exit(1);
        }

        if (children[i] == 0)
        {
            printf("Child %d: PID = %d\n", i + 1, getpid());

            sleep(3 - i);

            printf("Child %d finished\n", i + 1);
            exit(10 + i);
        }
    }

    // wait() waits for any one child
    printf("\nParent using wait()...\n");

    pid_t pid = wait(&status);

    if (WIFEXITED(status))
```

```
        exit(10 + i);
    }

    // wait() waits for any one child
    printf("\nParent using wait()...\n");

    pid_t pid = wait(&status);

    if (WIFEXITED(status))
    {
        printf("wait(): Child PID %d finished with status %d\n",
            pid, WEXITSTATUS(status));
    }

    // waitpid() waits for specific children
    printf("\nParent using waitpid()...\n");

    for (int i = 0; i < 3; i++)
    {
        pid = waitpid(children[i], &status, 0);

        if (WIFEXITED(status))
        {
            printf("waitpid(): Child PID %d finished with status %d\n",
                pid, WEXITSTATUS(status));
        }
    }

    printf("\nParent process finished.\n");

    return 0;
}
```

```

root@Priyavallika:~#
root@Priyavallika:~# nano wait_example.c
root@Priyavallika:~# gcc wait_example.c -o wait_example
root@Priyavallika:~# ./wait_example
Parent PID = 507
Child 1: PID = 508
Child 2: PID = 509

Parent using wait()...
Child 3: PID = 510
Child 3 finished
wait(): Child PID 510 finished with status 12

Parent using waitpid()...
Child 2 finished
Child 1 finished
waitpid(): Child PID 508 finished with status 10
waitpid(): Child PID 509 finished with status 11
waitpid(): Child PID -1 finished with status 11

Parent process finished.
root@Priyavallika:~# nano wait_example.c
root@Priyavallika:~# |

```

Observation

The parent process creates three child processes using the `fork()` system call. The child processes execute independently and terminate at different times. The `wait()` function allows the parent process to wait for any one child process to complete, while `waitpid()` allows the parent to wait for a specific child process using its process ID. Thus, both functions are used to synchronize the parent and child processes.

Result

The C program was successfully compiled and executed in Ubuntu. The program demonstrates process synchronization using `wait()` and `waitpid()`. It was observed that `wait()` waits for any child process to terminate, whereas `waitpid()` provides control to wait for a particular child process.

Task-2

Create a scenario where a child process becomes a zombie process. Investigate the process table and then modify the program to eliminate zombie processes using proper synchronization techniques.

```

GNU nano 7.2
#include <stdio.h>
#include <stdlib.h>
#include <unistd.h>

int main()
{
    pid_t pid = fork();

    if (pid < 0)
    {
        perror("fork failed");
        exit(1);
    }

    if (pid == 0)
    {
        printf("Child process: PID = %d\n", getpid());
        printf("Child is exiting...\n");
        exit(0);
    }
    else
    {
        printf("Parent process: PID = %d\n", getpid());
        printf("Child PID = %d\n", pid);
        printf("Parent is sleeping...\n");

        sleep(30);
    }

    return 0;
}

```

```

root@Priyavallika:~# nano wait_example.c
root@Priyavallika:~# gcc wait_example.c -o wait_example
root@Priyavallika:~# ./wait_example
Parent PID = 507
Child 1: PID = 508
Child 2: PID = 509

Parent using wait()...
Child 3: PID = 510
Child 3 finished
wait(): Child PID 510 finished with status 12

Parent using waitpid()...
Child 2 finished
Child 1 finished
waitpid(): Child PID 508 finished with status 10
waitpid(): Child PID 509 finished with status 11
waitpid(): Child PID -1 finished with status 11

Parent process finished.
root@Priyavallika:~# nano wait_example.c
root@Priyavallika:~# |

```

Observation:

The program successfully created a parent and child process using `fork()`. The child process terminated while the parent process continued executing and slept for 30 seconds. Since the parent did not call `wait()` to collect the child's termination status, the terminated child temporarily remained in the process table as a zombie process (Z state). After the parent process completed, the zombie was removed. The program was then modified to use proper synchronization with `wait()`, allowing the parent to collect the child's termination status and preventing the creation of a zombie process. **Result:**

A zombie process was successfully created and observed, and proper synchronization using `wait()` was used to eliminate it.